Lesson 22 material: Executive Order 9066: Discussion, Listening and Reading

6.1: Discussion

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Answer the following questions based on your experience and opinion. Read five classmates' posts and respond to two classmates pointing out any similarities or differences, asking clarifying questions, or giving your opinion on a point they make.

1. What historical events have prompted fear of others?
2. Why do people hate others who are not like them?

6.2: Listening-Why I Love a Country That Once Betrayed Me

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

2.2.2.1. Exercise 1-Listening Comprehension

Watch the video Why I Love a Country That Once Betrayed Me and build a basic understanding to prepare you for this chapter's reading. Answer the questions to check your comprehension.

1. Why were Takei and his family relocated to an internment camp?
a. They were not loyal to America.
b. They had recently immigrated from Japan.
c. They were of Japanese descent.
d. They did not support the war.
2. Which of the following describes Takei's experiences in the internment camp?
a. He thought it was normal.
b. He felt betrayed by his country.
c. He blamed his parents for his internment.
d. He understood he was being treated differently.
3. How were Japanese Americans treated when they volunteered for the army?
a. They were slapped across the face.
b. They were viewed as heroes.
c. They were accused of being spies.
d. They were treated as if they were non-citizens.
4. Why did Japanese Americans volunteer to fight in the war?
a. They wanted to prove they could be trusted.
b. They wanted to fight for what America stood for.
c. They needed to make money to send to their families.
d. They wanted to bring the war and internment to an end.

"Why I Love a Country That Once Betrayed Me" by George Takei is licensed by TED under CC BY-NC-ND 4.0

Links on the original page

- Why I Love a Country That Once Betrayed Me: https://www.ted.com/talks/george_takei_why_i_love_a_country_that_once_betrayed_me

6.3: Reading-Japanese Relocation During World War II

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

2.2.3.1. Exercise 2-Reading Comprehension

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow.

1President Franklin Delano Roosevelt declared that the day of the Japanese attack on Pearl Harbor, December 7, 1941, would live in infamy. The attack launched the United States fully into the two theaters of the world war. Prior to Pearl Harbor, the United States had been involved in the European war only by supplying England and other antifascist countries of Europe with necessary war materials.

2The attack on Pearl Harbor also launched a rash of fear about national security, especially on the West Coast. In February 1942, just two months after Pearl Harbor, President Roosevelt, as commander-in-chief, issued Executive Order 9066, which had the effect of relocating all persons of Japanese ancestry, both citizens and aliens, inland, outside of the Pacific military zone. The objectives of the order were to prevent espionage and to protect persons of Japanese descent from harm at the hands of Americans who had strong anti-Japanese attitudes.

3In Washington and Oregon, the eastern boundary of the military zone was an imaginary line along the rim of the Cascade Mountains; this line continued down the spine of California from north to south. From that line to the Pacific coast, the military restricted zones in those three states were defined.

4Roosevelt's order affected 117,000 people of Japanese descent, two-thirds of whom were native-born citizens of the United States. The Issei were the first generation of Japanese in this country; the Nisei were the second generation, numbering 70,000 American citizens at the time of internment. Within weeks, all persons of Japanese ancestry — whether citizens or enemy aliens, young or old, rich or poor — were ordered to assembly centers near their homes. Soon they were sent to permanent relocation centers outside the restricted military zones.

5For example, persons of Japanese ancestry in western Washington State were removed to the assembly center at the Puyallup Fairgrounds near Tacoma. From Puyallup to Pomona, internees found that a cowshed at a fairgrounds or a horse stall at a racetrack was home for several months before they were transported to a permanent location. Relocation centers were situated many miles inland, often in remote and desolate locales. Sites included Tule Lake, California; Minidoka, Idaho; Manzanar, California; Topaz, Utah; Jerome, Arkansas; Heart Mountain, Wyoming; Poston, Arizona; Granada, Colorado; and Rohwer, Arkansas.

6As four or five families with their sparse collections of clothing and possessions squeezed into shared barracks made of tar paper, life took on some familiar routines of socializing and school. However, eating in common facilities and having limited opportunities for work interrupted other social and cultural patterns. Persons who became troublesome were sent to a special camp at Tule Lake, California, where dissidents were housed.

7In 1943 and 1944 the government assembled a combat unit of Japanese Americans for the European theater. It became the 442d Regimental Combat Team and gained fame as the most highly decorated of World War II. Their military record reflected their patriotism.

8As the war drew to a close, the relocation centers were slowly evacuated. While some persons of Japanese ancestry returned to their home towns, others sought new surroundings. For example, the Japanese American community of Tacoma, Washington, had been sent to three different centers; only 30 percent returned to Tacoma after the war. Japanese Americans from Fresno had gone to Manzanar; 80 percent returned to their hometown.

(Picture: Image 16 "High School Campus at Heart Mountain, Wyoming" by the National Archives is in the public domain.)

Image 16 "*High School Campus at Heart Mountain, Wyoming* " *by the National Archives is in the public domain.*

9The internment of persons of Japanese ancestry during World War II sparked constitutional and political debate. In the 1940s, two men and one woman — Hirabayashi, Korematsu, and Endo — challenged the constitutionality of the relocation and curfew orders. While the men received negative judgments from the court, in the 1944 case ExParte Mitsuye Endo, the Supreme Court ruled that, "Mitsuye Endo is entitled to an unconditional release by the War Relocation Authority." Some people refer to the relocation centers as concentration camps; others view internment as an unfortunate episode, but a military necessity. During the Reagan-Bush years Congress passed Public Law 100-383 in 1988 which acknowledged the injustice of the internment, apologized for it, and provided a $20,000 cash payment to each person who was interned.

10One of the most stunning ironies in this episode of American civil liberties was articulated by an internee who, when told that the Japanese were put in those camps for their own protection, countered, "If we were put there for our protection, why were the guns at the guard towers pointed inward, instead of outward?"

1. PART A-Which statement identifies the central idea of the text?

a. The internment of Japanese Americans was mainly for their protection against discriminatory citizens.

b. While internment was said to be for the protection of Japanese Americans, they were denied constitutional rights and treated like enemy prisoners.
c. Japanese American internment was necessary to ensure the national security of the United States.
d. It wasn't until Japanese Americans participated in WWII that they earned back the right to be viewed as citizens rather than potential spies.

2. PART B: Which detail from the text best supports the answer to Part A?

a. "eating in common facilities and having limited opportunities for work interrupted other social and cultural patterns." (Paragraph 6)
b. "In 1943 and 1944 the government assembled a combat unit of Japanese Americans for the European theater. It became the 442d Regimental Combat Team and gained fame as the most highly decorated of World War II." (Paragraph 7)
c. "Some people refer to the relocation centers as concentration camps; others view internment as an unfortunate episode, but a military necessity." (Paragraph 9)
d. "'If we were put there for our protection, why were the guns at the guard towers pointed inward, instead of outward?'" (Paragraph 10)

3. PART A: What is a "dissident" as it is referred to in paragraph 6?

a. protestor
b. victim
c. prisoner
d. advocate

4. PART B: Which quote from the text best supports the answer to Part A?

a. "persons of Japanese ancestry in western Washington State" (Paragraph 5)
b. "four or five families with their sparse collections of clothing and possessions" (Paragraph 6)
c. "Persons who became troublesome" (Paragraph 6)
d. "a combat unit of Japanese Americans" (Paragraph 7)

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Links on the original page

- High School Campus at Heart Mountain, Wyoming: https://www.archives.gov/files/education/lessons/japanese-relocation/images/high-school.gif
- Japanese Relocation During World War II: https://www.commonlit.org/en/texts/japanese-relocation-during-world-war-ii
- CommonLit: https://www.commonlit.org/en

16.5: Chapter 5

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

4.5.1. Listening Comprehension

00:12 I'm a veteran of the starship Enterprise.

00:16 I soared through the galaxy

00:19 driving a huge starship

00:22 with a crew made up of people

00:24 from all over this world,

00:26 many different races, many different cultures,

00:30 many different heritages,

00:32 all working together,

00:34 and our mission was to explore strange new worlds,

00:37 to seek out new life and new civilizations,

00:41 to boldly go where no one has gone before.

00:46 Well —

00:48 (Applause) —

00:54 I am the grandson of immigrants from Japan

00:59 who went to America,

01:01 boldly going to a strange new world,

01:05 seeking new opportunities.

01:08 My mother was born in Sacramento, California.

01:11 My father was a San Franciscan.

01:13 They met and married in Los Angeles,

01:16 and I was born there.

01:20 I was four years old

01:22 when Pearl Harbor was bombed

01:24 on December 7, 1941 by Japan,

01:29 and overnight, the world was plunged

01:33 into a world war.

01:36 America suddenly was swept up

01:39 by hysteria.

01:43 Japanese-Americans,

01:45 American citizens of Japanese ancestry,

01:48 were looked on

01:49 with suspicion and fear

01:53 and with outright hatred

01:56 simply because we happened to look like

01:59 the people that bombed Pearl Harbor.

02:01 And the hysteria grew and grew

02:05 until in February 1942,

02:08 the president of the United States,

02:11 Franklin Delano Roosevelt,
02:13 ordered all Japanese-Americans
02:15 on the West Coast of America
02:18 to be summarily rounded up
02:20 with no charges, with no trial,
02:24 with no due process.
02:26 Due process, this is a core pillar
02:29 of our justice system.
02:30 That all disappeared.
02:33 We were to be rounded up
02:35 and imprisoned in 10 barbed-wire prison camps
02:39 in some of the most desolate places in America:
02:43 the blistering hot desert of Arizona,
02:47 the sultry swamps of Arkansas,
02:50 the wastelands of Wyoming, Idaho, Utah, Colorado,
02:54 and two of the most desolate places in California.
02:59 On April 20th, I celebrated my fifth birthday,
03:04 and just a few weeks after my birthday,
03:08 my parents got my younger brother,
03:10 my baby sister and me
03:12 up very early one morning,
03:15 and they dressed us hurriedly.
03:18 My brother and I were in the living room
03:20 looking out the front window,
03:23 and we saw two soldiers marching up our driveway.
03:27 They carried bayonets on their rifles.
03:31 They stomped up the front porch
03:34 and banged on the door.
03:36 My father answered it,
03:39 and the soldiers ordered us out of our home.
03:43 My father gave my brother and me
03:46 small luggages to carry,
03:47 and we walked out and stood on the driveway
03:51 waiting for our mother to come out,
03:54 and when my mother finally came out,
03:57 she had our baby sister in one arm,
04:00 a huge duffel bag in the other,
04:04 and tears were streaming down both her cheeks.
04:09 I will never be able to forget that scene.
04:13 It is burned into my memory.
04:17 We were taken from our home
04:20 and loaded on to train cars
04:22 with other Japanese-American families.

04:25 There were guards stationed
04:27 at both ends of each car,
04:30 as if we were criminals.
04:33 We were taken two thirds of the way across the country,
04:37 rocking on that train for four days and three nights,
04:41 to the swamps of Arkansas.
04:45 I still remember the barbed wire fence
04:47 that confined me.
04:50 I remember the tall sentry tower
04:52 with the machine guns pointed at us.
04:56 I remember the searchlight that followed me
04:59 when I made the night runs
05:01 from my barrack to the latrine.
05:04 But to five-year-old me,
05:06 I thought it was kind of nice that they'd lit the way
05:08 for me to pee.
05:12 I was a child,
05:13 too young to understand the circumstances
05:16 of my being there.
05:19 Children are amazingly adaptable.
05:23 What would be grotesquely abnormal
05:27 became my normality
05:30 in the prisoner of war camps.
05:33 It became routine for me to line up three times a day
05:37 to eat lousy food in a noisy mess hall.
05:42 It became normal for me to go with my father
05:44 to bathe in a mass shower.
05:47 Being in a prison, a barbed-wire prison camp,
05:51 became my normality.
05:55 When the war ended,
05:56 we were released,
05:58 and given a one-way ticket
06:00 to anywhere in the United States.
06:04 My parents decided to go back home
06:06 to Los Angeles,
06:09 but Los Angeles was not a welcoming place.
06:13 We were penniless.
06:14 Everything had been taken from us,
06:17 and the hostility was intense.
06:19 Our first home was on Skid Row
06:22 in the lowest part of our city,
06:27 living with derelicts, drunkards
06:30 and crazy people,

06:32 the stench of urine all over,
06:34 on the street, in the alley,
06:37 in the hallway.
06:40 It was a horrible experience,
06:42 and for us kids, it was terrorizing.
06:46 I remember once
06:48 a drunkard came staggering down,
06:51 fell down right in front of us,
06:54 and threw up.
06:55 My baby sister said, "Mama, let's go back home,"
07:01 because behind barbed wires
07:03 was for us
07:06 home.
07:08 My parents worked hard
07:10 to get back on their feet.
07:12 We had lost everything.
07:13 They were at the middle of their lives
07:16 and starting all over.
07:17 They worked their fingers to the bone,
07:20 and ultimately they were able
07:23 to get the capital together to buy
07:26 a three-bedroom home in a nice neighborhood.
07:29 And I was a teenager,
07:30 and I became very curious
07:32 about my childhood imprisonment.
07:35 I had read civics books that told me about
07:38 the ideals of American democracy.
07:42 All men are created equal,
07:45 we have an inalienable right
07:48 to life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness,
07:53 and I couldn't quite make that fit
07:55 with what I knew to be my childhood imprisonment.
07:58 I read history books,
08:00 and I couldn't find anything about it.
08:03 And so I engaged my father after dinner
08:07 in long, sometimes heated conversations.
08:12 We had many, many conversations like that,
08:15 and what I got from them
08:17 was my father's wisdom.
08:19 He was the one that suffered the most
08:22 under those conditions of imprisonment,
08:25 and yet he understood American democracy.
08:29 He told me that our democracy

08:32 is a people's democracy,
08:34 and it can be as great as the people can be,
08:37 but it is also as fallible as people are.
08:42 He told me that American democracy
08:45 is vitally dependent on good people
08:49 who cherish the ideals of our system
08:53 and actively engage in the process
08:56 of making our democracy work.
08:59 And he took me to a campaign headquarters —
09:03 the governor of Illinois was running for the presidency —
09:07 and introduced me to American electoral politics.
09:11 And he also told me about
09:14 young Japanese-Americans
09:15 during the Second World War.
09:19 When Pearl Harbor was bombed,
09:21 young Japanese-Americans, like all young Americans,
09:24 rushed to their draft board
09:27 to volunteer to fight for our country.
09:30 That act of patriotism
09:33 was answered with a slap in the face.
09:37 We were denied service,
09:40 and categorized as enemy non-alien.
09:46 It was outrageous to be called an enemy
09:49 when you're volunteering to fight for your country,
09:52 but that was compounded with the word "non-alien,"
09:56 which is a word that means
10:00 "citizen" in the negative.
10:04 They even took the word "citizen" away from us,
10:07 and imprisoned them for a whole year.
10:12 And then the government realized
10:14 that there's a wartime manpower shortage,
10:18 and as suddenly as they'd rounded us up,
10:23 they opened up the military for service
10:25 by young Japanese-Americans.
10:28 It was totally irrational,
10:30 but the amazing thing,
10:33 the astounding thing,
10:35 is that thousands of young
10:37 Japanese-American men and women
10:40 again went from behind those barbed-wire fences,
10:44 put on the same uniform as that of our guards,
10:47 leaving their families in imprisonment,
10:51 to fight for this country.

10:53 They said that they were going to fight
10:55 not only to get their families out
10:58 from behind those barbed-wire fences,
11:01 but because they cherished the very ideal
11:04 of what our government stands for,
11:06 should stand for,
11:08 and that was being abrogated
11:11 by what was being done.
11:15 All men are created equal.
11:17 And they went to fight for this country.
11:21 They were put into a segregated
11:22 all Japanese-American unit
11:25 and sent to the battlefields of Europe,
11:27 and they threw themselves into it.
11:30 They fought with amazing,
11:33 incredible courage and valor.
11:37 They were sent out on the most dangerous missions
11:40 and they sustained the highest combat casualty rate
11:43 of any unit proportionally.
11:47 There is one battle that illustrates that.
11:50 It was a battle for the Gothic Line.
11:53 The Germans were embedded
11:56 in this mountain hillside,
11:58 rocky hillside,
12:00 in impregnable caves,
12:02 and three allied battalions
12:06 had been pounding away at it
12:07 for six months,
12:09 and they were stalemated.
12:11 The 442nd was called in
12:14 to add to the fight,
12:18 but the men of the 442nd
12:20 came up with a unique
12:23 but dangerous idea:
12:25 The backside of the mountain
12:27 was a sheer rock cliff.
12:30 The Germans thought an attack from the backside
12:33 would be impossible.
12:36 The men of the 442nd decided to do the impossible.
12:40 On a dark, moonless night,
12:44 they began scaling that rock wall,
12:48 a drop of more than 1,000 feet,
12:52 in full combat gear.

12:54 They climbed all night long

12:57 on that sheer cliff.

13:02 In the darkness,

13:04 some lost their handhold

13:06 or their footing

13:07 and they fell to their deaths

13:10 in the ravine below.

13:12 They all fell silently.

13:16 Not a single one cried out,

13:19 so as not to give their position away.

13:22 The men climbed for eight hours straight,

13:26 and those who made it to the top

13:29 stayed there until the first break of light,

13:33 and as soon as light broke,

13:36 they attacked.

13:38 The Germans were surprised,

13:40 and they took the hill

13:41 and broke the Gothic Line.

13:44 A six-month stalemate

13:47 was broken by the 442nd

13:49 in 32 minutes.

13:52 It was an amazing act,

13:56 and when the war ended,

13:58 the 442nd returned to the United States

14:02 as the most decorated unit

14:04 of the entire Second World War.

14:07 They were greeted back on the White House Lawn

14:10 by President Truman, who said to them,

14:12 "You fought not only the enemy

14:16 but prejudice, and you won."

14:20 They are my heroes.

14:24 They clung to their belief

14:27 in the shining ideals of this country,

14:30 and they proved that being an American

14:34 is not just for some people,

14:37 that race is not how we define being an American.

14:43 They expanded what it means to be an American,

14:46 including Japanese-Americans

14:49 that were feared and suspected and hated.

14:53 They were change agents,

14:56 and they left for me

14:59 a legacy.

15:01 They are my heroes

15:03 and my father is my hero,

15:05 who understood democracy

15:07 and guided me through it.

15:11 They gave me a legacy,

15:13 and with that legacy comes a responsibility,

15:17 and I am dedicated

15:19 to making my country

15:21 an even better America,

15:24 to making our government

15:27 an even truer democracy,

15:30 and because of the heroes that I have

15:34 and the struggles that we've gone through,

15:37 I can stand before you

15:39 as a gay Japanese-American,

15:42 but even more than that,

15:45 I am a proud American.

15:49 Thank you very much.

15:51 (Applause)

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4.5.2. Exercise-Listening Practice-Passive Voice

Listen to the new years traditions from around the world. Complete the sentences using passive voice.

Video: https://youtu.be/pxCswHrapP8

1. Twelve grapes are eaten to bring good luck. The grapes symbolize the 12 months in the year.
2. Negative energy is removed when every corner of the home is brushed with a broom.
3. Purple and gold decorations are hung in the house to bring prosperity and health.
4. New clothes especially red ones are worn to attract prosperity and passion.
5. Donations are given to those in need to make room for what the new year will bring.
6. Money is placed in shoes to show economic stability.
7. Water is thrown out the window or door to let go of suffering, tears, or sorrow.

Links on the original page

- Why I Love a Country That Once Betrayed Me: https://www.ted.com/talks/george_takei_why_i_love_a_country_that_once_betrayed_me
- new years traditions from around the world: https://youtu.be/pxCswHrapP8